

Pronunciation

B C D F G H J L M N P R S T V W Y

C = /k/ (cake) · H = /h/ or soft rasp · J = /dʒ/ (jello) · R = /r/ flap (American butter)

Vowels: A /ɑ/ (father) · E /ɛ/ (cellar) · I /i/ (creek) · O /ɔ/ (door) · U /u/ (flu)

E and O closed like Spanish are fine too.

Stress: penultimate syllable — iLlru

1. Pronouns and Possession

	singular	plural
1st	nim I	nima we
2nd	run you	runa you (pl)
3rd	hay he / she / they	haya they (pl)

Pronouns are often dropped when context is clear. Affirmative sentences default to nim, and questions to run, so you don't repeat them as much as in English.

Possessive: pronoun before the word · for nouns, use de

nim bo = my house

bo de miwo = dog's house

2. The Four Core Markers

a [subject] · i [verb] · e [direct object] · u [indirect object]

Mnemonics: Actor · Initiates · Engaged · Unto

a nim i anona e mocen u run

I give chocolate to you

More often (nim dropped in affirmative): i anona e mocen u run

You may drop markers when context is clear. a drops the easiest, and then e.

a...a means is / are:

a hay a yalen = he/she/they is tall · a bo a yamirli = the house is old

Word order is flexible because roles are marked: e mocen u run i anona is also common.

3. Describing Words

A modifier goes right before the word it describes.

mocen mouje = chocolate drink

pohem mocen mouje = hot chocolate drink

4. Two Core Prepositions

en = location / time ("in, on, at")

de = source / possession ("of, from")

a run en bo = you are at home

a hay i anifi de bo = he/she/they comes from the house

5. Coordination and Contrast

su	and / with	run i mo e moaria su mocen	you eat apple and chocolate
mai	but	hay i anvu, mai nim i doun	she goes, but I don't
dou	or	nim i mo e moaria dou mocen	I eat apple or chocolate
eta	so, therefore	a nim a tou, eta nim i bonfene	I'm tired, so I lie down

6. Negation

Add -um to the word you want to negate.

i dami a moaria = there is an apple

i damium a moaria = there is no apple

7. Questions and "what/that" Clauses

Raise intonation for yes/no questions. No structural change.

run i mo? = are you eating?

ce = what (question) · ca = that / which (connector)

ce en bo? = what's in the house?

Build more question words with ce + a domain word:

word	meaning
cei	who (what + person)
cedom	where (what + place)
celi	when (what + time)
ceora	why (what + reason)
cenon	how (what + way)

In statements, swap ce → ca: ceora → caora (because) · cedom → cadom (where) · etc.

run i ilianum cadom bo = you know-not where the house

8. Verb Stacking

To chain two verbs, repeat i before each one. No "to" needed.

run i dairan i anelem en bo = you like to stay home

hay i do i mo = he/she/they can eat

haya i dai i anvu = they want to go

9. Compounds

-a suffix bonds modifiers and noun into a single concept:

waa jasru	waa (sea) + jasru (bend)	= bay
lufua bei	lufua (air) + bei (vehicle)	= airplane
yalgaia mus	yalgaia (small) + mus (bug)	= ant
waa dom	waa (sea) + dom (land)	= island

Hyphenated forms fuse two words into one expression:

falen-li	falen (child) + li (time)	= childhood
tohpu-vanvu	tohpu (sad) + vanvu (walk)	= to trudge
bo-bortal	bo (house) + bortal (enter)	= to enter a house

If you're unsure which form to use, just use whatever feels right. Chances are, either works!

10. Vocabulary

Most Oravia words are formed as (sub)cluster + root. A cluster is the first sound(s) and signals the semantic domain; a root adds a second layer of meaning.

moalen (banana) = MO (food) + A (fruit subcluster) + LEN (root: long)

~260 (sub)clusters and roots were discovered using word-embeddings. Once you know the patterns, you can make educated guesses and learn words faster.

Starter Vocabulary

mo	eat / food	bo	house	beivu	car	leirih	tree
falen	child	fare	parent	faejor	woman	faejal	man
faibor	spouse	eofa	friend	elihei	person	anye	make, do
anvu	go	anona	give	anifou	need	ando	can
none	have	anidai	want	dami	exist	dairan	like
ilian	know	ilaluan	speak	elemi	live, life	yuba	good
ti	bad	yalen	tall/long	litam	day	liyar	morning
noli	now	noi	here / this	ho noi	there / that	oipoh	exciting

A		
● AN	action	
	<i>PIE *h₂en-</i>	
● ANE	static movement	
	<i>Latin manere</i>	
● ● ANI	movement towards	
	<i>Latin animus</i>	
● ANO	movement away	
	<i>Japanese ano</i>	
● APA	physical movement	
	<i>Sanskrit apad</i>	
● AS	involuntary bodily functions	
	<i>PIE *h₁es-</i>	
● ASE	affectionate contact	
	<i>Sanskrit āśleṣa</i>	
● ASI	orifice intake/expulsion	
	<i>Sanskrit āśya</i>	
● ASU	involuntary vocal acts	
	<i>Sanskrit asu</i>	
B		
● BE	travel	
	<i>Bengali berāṇo</i>	
● BEI	vehicles	
	<i>Mandarin bèi</i>	
● ● BO	home interior	
	<i>Arabic bayt</i>	
● BOE	house spaces	
	<i>English bower</i>	
● BON	furniture	
	<i>French banc</i>	
● BOR	house structure	
	<i>English bore/board</i>	
● BOS	hygiene fixtures	
	<i>Malay basuh</i>	
C		
● CAI	flat	
	<i>Sanskrit caya</i>	
● CATI	constraint	
	<i>Latin catena</i>	
● CE	what?	
	<i>Latin quid</i>	
● CI	sharp	
	<i>Mandarin ci</i>	
● ● CIU	creative products	
	<i>Latin creatus</i>	
● ● CO	communication	
	<i>Latin communicare</i>	
● COU	written communication	
	<i>French courier</i>	
D		
● DA	evaluation	
	<i>Arabic dhā</i>	
● DAE	epistemic	
	<i>Japanese 代 (dai)</i>	
● DAL	pattern	
	<i>Swahili dalili</i>	
● DAN	emphasis	
	<i>Mandarin dàn</i>	
● DAN	options	
● DAO	serious	
● DAU	distance	
● DE	origin, from	
	<i>Latin de</i>	
● DEL	logic	
	<i>Latin delineare</i>	
● DI	stripe, finger	
	<i>Sanskrit diś</i>	
● DO	regulations	
	<i>Mandarin dào</i>	
● DOH	enforcement	
	<i>Hausa dokar</i>	
● DOI	opposing	
	<i>Arabic dīdd</i>	
● DOM	place	
	<i>Latin domus</i>	
● DON	show	
● DORA	bond	
	<i>Latin adorare</i>	
● DUR	hardness	
	<i>Latin durus</i>	
E		
● ELA	religious	
	<i>Aramaic Elah</i>	
● ELE	self-expansion	
	<i>Greek eleutheros</i>	
● ELI	virtue	
	<i>Greek ethikos</i>	
● ELO	prosocial	
	<i>Latin eloqui</i>	
● EO	social	
	<i>Greek eu-</i>	
● EOD	social interactions	
	<i>Japanese deau</i>	
● EOM	events and gatherings	
	<i>Korean moim</i>	
F		
● ● FA	family relationships	
	<i>Latin familia</i>	
● FAE	gender	
● FAI	partnership, marriage	
	<i>Latin foedus</i>	
● FAL	young ones	
	<i>Latin filia</i>	
● FE	halting	
	<i>Turkish fren</i>	
● FENE	rest	
● FI	inside	
	<i>Swahili -fika</i>	
● FOU	lack	
	<i>English few</i>	
● FU	lightness	
	<i>Mandarin fú</i>	
G		
● GA	evaluation	
	<i>English gauge</i>	
● GAJ	small	
	<i>English grain</i>	
● GALI	coffee	
	<i>Arabic qahwa</i>	
● GAN	ranking	
	<i>Japanese 格 (kaku)</i>	
● GAO	value assessment	
● GE	finances	
	<i>Proto-Gmc *geldan</i>	
● GEL	trading	
	<i>German Geld</i>	
● GI	boldness	
● GO	half	
	<i>Japanese 五 (go)</i>	
H		
● HAI	message	
	<i>Swahili habari</i>	
● HE	fiction tropes	
	<i>Greek heros</i>	
● HEH	antagonist tropes	
	<i>English hex</i>	
● ● HEI	protagonist tropes	
● HELA	projecting outward	
	<i>Sanskrit hel</i>	
● HEM	warmth	
● HEO	background	
● HISA	fire	
	<i>Polynesian ahi</i>	
● HOU	shadow	
	<i>Mandarin hòu</i>	
● HUI	ethereal	
	<i>Mandarin hún</i>	
I		
● IL	objects of inquiry	
	<i>Latin ille</i>	
● ILA	sharing information	
	<i>Arabic ilā</i>	
● ILI	cognition	
	<i>Port. inteligência</i>	
● ILO	uncertain knowledge	
	<i>English illusion</i>	
J		
● JA	tools	
	<i>Arabic jihāz</i>	
● JAE	container	
	<i>Port./Sp. jarra</i>	
● JAH	cutting tools	
	<i>Japanese 刃 (ha)</i>	
● JAS	gripping/fastening tools	
	<i>Japanese hasamu</i>	
● JE	geometrics	
	<i>Mandarin jié</i>	
● JEN	location	
	<i>Japanese 前 (mae)</i>	
● JEO	geometric positions	
	<i>Greek geo-</i>	
● JO	materials	
	<i>Korean jaeryo</i>	
● JOL	material types	
● JU	deceive	
	<i>Hindi jhūṭh</i>	
● JUI	temporary	
	<i>Hindi jugāṛ</i>	
L		
● LA	happiness	
	<i>cross-lingual</i>	
● LAN	balance	
	<i>Hindi saṃtulana</i>	
● LANO	round, around	
● ● LE	environment	
	<i>PIE *lendh-</i>	
● LEA	landscape	
	<i>English lea</i>	
● LEI	plants	
	<i>Mandarin lěi</i>	
● LEM	keeping	
	<i>Greek lēmma</i>	
● LEN	long	
	<i>Latin longus</i>	
● LENO	ground	
	<i>Spanish llano</i>	
● ● LI	time	
	<i>Mandarin 时 (lǐ)</i>	
● LIA	resonant	
	<i>Hindi laya</i>	
● LIL	muscle	
	<i>Arabic lif</i>	
● LIMEL	evening	
	<i>Arabic layl</i>	
● LIRA	mark	
	<i>Latin littera</i>	
● LITE	clock time	
	<i>Greek lepto</i>	
● LIU	other	
	<i>Latin alius</i>	
● LOA	completeness	
	<i>Hawaiian loa</i>	
● ● LU	atmosphere, outside	
	<i>Latin lux</i>	
● LUA	flow	
	<i>Arabic lujja</i>	
● LUAN	tongue	
	<i>Arabic lisān</i>	
● LUFU	air	
	<i>German Luft</i>	
● LUN	seasons	
	<i>Latin luna</i>	
M		
● MA	cooking food	
	<i>Arabic maṭbakh</i>	
● MA	matter	
● MAE	tubers and grains	
	<i>Mandarin mǐ</i>	
● MAL	bread and dairy	
	<i>German Mehl</i>	
● MAS	spices and seasonings	
	<i>Arabic masāla</i>	
● MI	bigger animals	
	<i>Swahili mnyama</i>	
● MI	existence, being	

● MIE	appearance <i>Mandarin miàn</i>	● RAS	about society <i>Arabic rasm</i>	● TUM	weapons <i>Indonesian tombak</i>
● MIO	wild animals <i>Hindi mrg</i>	● REL	up, high <i>Latin relevare</i>	V	
● MIO	support	● REN	honor <i>Mandarin 仁 (rén)</i>	● VA	core <i>Sanskrit vāyu</i>
● MIR	lots of <i>Sanskrit mīr</i>	● REVA	accurate <i>Latin revelare</i>	● VABO	cozy, body home <i>va + bo</i>
●● MO	food, eating <i>Hawaiian moku</i>	● RIH	higher, rising	● VAL	ice <i>Italian valanga</i>
● MOA	fruits <i>Polynesian moa</i>	●● RO	knowledge <i>Japanese 羅 (ron)</i>	● VAN	limbs <i>Hindi bāṃh</i>
● MOL	food containers	● ROE	formal education <i>Latin rogare</i>	● VAN	private
●● MU	smaller animals <i>Swahili mdudu</i>	● ROU	written knowledge <i>Latin rotulus</i>	● VAR	face <i>Sanskrit vaktram</i>
● MUH	flying animals <i>Persian morgh</i>	● RU	bend <i>Arabic rukū'</i>	● VARI	back
N		● RUL	habit <i>English rule</i>	● VEI	health issues <i>Sanskrit vaidya</i>
● NA	giving <i>Proto-Bantu *-nab-</i>	S		● VEL	medical treatments <i>Latin valere</i>
● NALA	urgency <i>Arabic nafara</i>	● SAR	hang <i>Turkish sarkmak</i>	● VER	safety <i>German Wehr</i>
● NE	quantifiers <i>Swahili na</i>	● SARI	sun <i>Sanskrit sūrya</i>	●● VI	interior body <i>Latin vita</i>
● NEN	power and violence <i>Latin imponens</i>	● SAU	start <i>Hindi śūrū</i>	● VIO	change, exchange <i>Latin via</i>
● NI	new <i>Hindi nayā</i>	● SE	machines <i>Mandarin shèbèi</i>	● VIR	organs <i>Latin viscera</i>
● NIU	some <i>Tagalog niyon</i>	● SEL	coding <i>English select</i>	● VIR	method
●● NO	function words <i>Latin non</i>	● SEM	system <i>Greek systema</i>	● VOA	constraint <i>Mandarin wéi</i>
● NON	path	● SERI	series <i>Latin series</i>	● VON	external body
● NOR	relation to reference <i>Latin norma</i>	● SI	processes <i>PIE *sekʷ-</i>	● VOR	threat <i>English horror</i>
● NOU	low, falling <i>Arabic nawm</i>	● SIO	games <i>Latin iocus</i>	● VOS	cleaning actions <i>Swahili -osha</i>
● NU	limit <i>Greek nu</i>	● SIO	document	● VU	movement <i>Mandarin bù</i>
O		● SOI	speed	● VUSON	slow movement <i>vu + son</i>
● ODU	top	● SU	alongside	W	
● OI	fun <i>Yiddish oy</i>	● SUS	hearing <i>Latin auscultare</i>	●● WA	sea, water bodies <i>Polynesian wai</i>
● OM	music <i>Sanskrit om</i>	T		● WI	geographical orientation <i>Arabic wayn</i>
● ORA	idea	● TA	hand <i>Latin tangere</i>	● WIL	human-made geography <i>Latin villa</i>
P		● TAI	guide <i>Mandarin dài</i>	● WIM	natural geography
● PA	paper <i>Latin papyrus</i>	● TAL	door <i>Persian tāq</i>	● WOL	wide
● PAI	foot <i>Hindi pair</i>	● TALE	passage <i>Welsh taith</i>	Y	
● PARO	front <i>Latin pro/prae</i>	● TAM	one <i>Arabic tamām</i>	● YA	objective qualities <i>Swahili -a</i>
● PILI	delicate	● TAN	big <i>Greek titan</i>	● YAH	representation, invitation
● PO	components <i>Latin portio</i>	● TAR	regulate <i>Arabic tartīb</i>	● YAL	texture qualities
● POA	chemical <i>Mandarin pào</i>	● TEL	image <i>English television</i>	● YAR	size qualities <i>Arabic ṭawīl</i>
● POH	energy <i>Greek pyr</i>	● TELI	moment	● YAR	light <i>Arabic ḍiyā'</i>
● POI	liquids	● TER	count <i>Latin ter</i>	● YE	clothing and fabric <i>Turkish yelken</i>
● POPO	echo <i>onomatopoeia</i>	●● TI	harm, damage <i>Tamil tī</i>	● YEL	joining <i>English yoke</i>
● PU	loss, sadness <i>Persian pūc</i>	● TIRA	fungus	● YEN	printed <i>Mandarin yīn</i>
● PUNI	command <i>Latin punire</i>	● TIU	types of harm <i>Sanskrit tīvra</i>	● YES	garments
● PUPI	water falling <i>onomatopoeia</i>	●● TO	suffering, distress <i>Indonesian tobat</i>	● YO	colors <i>Yoruba yọ</i>
R		● TOH	emotional suffering <i>English torment</i>	● YOL	sky and ocean
● RA	society <i>Sanskrit rastra</i>	● TOS	interpersonal suffering	● YOYO	oscillate <i>onomatopoeia</i>
● RAI	governance <i>Hindi rāj</i>	● TOU	physical depletion	● YU	subjective qualities
● RAM	sudden <i>Latin raptim</i>	● TU	conflict <i>Latin tumultus</i>	● YUN	personal characteristics
● RAN	media, public discourse <i>Hindi raṅgmanc</i>	● TUL	crash <i>English tumble</i>	● YUN	mist <i>Mandarin yún</i>